



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting September 19th 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s1ajvht_rg8
Publication Date	2022-09-24T22:12:03Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 19, 2022

Recorded Start Time: [00:00:25](#)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

This section has been omitted as the transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer on Monday, September 19, 2022, at [00:00:25](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. King, Mr. Henry, Mr. Riggin (also referred to as Reagan), Mr. Burke, and Ms. Smith.
 - **Absent:** None noted.

- **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly specified by name, though conducting the meeting proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:38.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were approved following a motion and second, with roll call votes recorded as affirmative by Mr. Henry, Mr. King, and Mr. Riffin 00:01:25.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Presentation & Funding Request: Guardian Advocates Incorporated 00:01:36

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator) and Linda Johnson (representant of Guardian Advocates Inc. / VASIA program).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Emily Anderson and Linda Johnson presented on the Guardian Advocates organization, which acts as legal guardians for seniors and incapacitated adults who lack family or friends to represent them. The program is expanding to Delaware County in conjunction with local judges and is partially funded by a VASIA (Volunteer Advocates for Seniors and Incapacitated Adults) grant from the Indiana Supreme Court, which requires a local funding match. The presenters requested financial support for their local match. Commissioners expressed strong support for the program and discussed how it intersects with Adult Protective Services.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. A motion was made and seconded to allocate \$10,000 out of health and wellness EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds to Guardian Advocates for the current year 00:15:08. Passed via roll call vote with affirmative votes from Mr. King, Mr. Henry, and Mr. Riffin 00:15:29.

Election Board Pay Increase Proposal 00:15:57

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Spangler, representing the Delaware County Election Board.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Rick Spangler presented a proposal backed by minutes from the Election Board's September 1st meeting to raise pay rates for election room workers and poll workers to help address ongoing recruitment and staffing struggles. Spangler confirmed that the cost was already accounted for within the clerk's budget and required no additional appropriation.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. A motion to approve the pay increase request was made, seconded, and passed via roll call vote with affirmative votes from Mr. Henry,

Mr. King, and Mr. Riggin 00:17:09.

Selection of Mental Health Provider & Construction Contractor for Justice Center 00:17:48

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Staff/Administrator).
- **Deliberation Summary:** John reported on responses to Requests for Proposals (RFPs) issued for the mental health facility at the Justice Center. While one response was received from Batten Woodruff Contractors for development, three proposals were received for the mental health operator. Wellpath (from Nashville, Tennessee) submitted the most comprehensive and detailed proposal meeting all criteria. John recommended selecting Wellpath as the mental health provider and Batten Woodruff as the construction contractor.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - *Mental Health Provider:* Wellpath selected as the provider. Motion made, seconded, and approved via roll call vote (Mr. King, Mr. Henry, Mr. Riggin voting yes) 00:19:00.
 - *Construction Contractor:* Batten Woodruff Contracting approved as the contractor. Motion made, seconded, and approved via roll call vote (Mr. Henry, Mr. King, Mr. Riggin voting yes) 00:19:13.

Second Reading: Ordinance 2022-22 00:19:56

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board briefly discussed Ordinance 2022-22 scheduled for a second reading, noting that work on the matter was ongoing.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for a couple of weeks. Motion made, seconded, and approved via roll call vote (Mr. Henry, Mr. King, Mr. Riggin voting yes) 00:20:00.

Payment of Claims 00:21:35

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of regular claims totaling \$1,906,987.22 and ARP (American Rescue Plan) claims totaling up to \$72,004.85.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. Motion made, seconded, and passed via roll call vote with affirmative votes from Mr. King, Mr. Henry, and Mr. Riggin 00:21:53.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No citizen speakers participated during the general open public comment period.*
Mr. Burke confirmed no comments were submitted via Facebook 00:22:01.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Mr. Gould announced an upcoming annual stand-out event at the fairgrounds taking place the following day from 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM 00:20:32.
 - Commissioners offered thoughts and prayers to the Richmond Police Department following the loss of an officer in the line of duty 00:21:10.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to recess/adjourn was made and seconded, passing via roll call vote with affirmative votes from Mr. Henry, Mr. King, and Mr. Riggins 00:22:11.
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